

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Dental Assisting English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Dental assistants and dental support staff.

Fictional English practice, not dental training. Permitted duties, supervision, imaging authorization, and infection-prevention procedures depend on local requirements and qualifications. Refer diagnosis, treatment decisions, informed-consent questions, and aftercare advice to the authorized dental professional.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Clarifying the appointment purpose

Check the appointment mismatch and explain what is confirmed.

02 Room readiness and safe clarification

Name the unresolved check and ask for an authorized pause or alternative.

03 Chairside requests and read-backs

Identify the exact missing word or detail instead of silently guessing.

04 Imaging questions and authorization

Respond to an imaging question by identifying the right decision-maker and preserving the patient's question.

05 Patient comfort, questions, and pauses

Acknowledge the concern and obtain a clinician-led explanation before a decision.

06 Records, identifiers, and factual handoffs

Identify conflicting sources and obtain an authorized record check.

07 Laboratory cases and delivery expectations

Link a delivery risk to a concrete update time and authorized scheduling decision.

08 Aftercare questions and follow-up calls

Identify the unclear instruction and obtain an appropriate authorized response.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Clarifying the appointment purpose

Check the appointment mismatch and explain what is confirmed.

SITUATION

A fictional patient arrives expecting a filling today. The schedule shows a thirty-minute consultation, and no procedure is confirmed. The dentist can clarify the purpose before the patient decides whether to continue.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

consultation - A visit for discussing or assessing a concern with the appropriate dental professional.

procedure - A particular dental action or treatment, not simply any visit to the office.

appointment slot - A reserved period in the appointment schedule.

treatment plan - The clinician's proposed course of dental care, which requires appropriate explanation and agreement.

Useful word combinations

confirm the appointment type: check what kind of visit was booked

allow enough time: reserve a suitable period without promising an unapproved treatment

raise a concern: bring a question to the clinician's attention

review the treatment plan: ask the authorized professional to explain the proposed care

LESSON 01 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Separate a booked discussion from a promised treatment

3. Notice the language

'Consultation' and 'procedure' are not interchangeable. Describe the booking you can see, acknowledge the patient's understanding, and ask the authorized person to clarify without blaming the patient or promising treatment.

The schedule shows ____; you were expecting ____.

I haven't confirmed ____ for today's visit.

Let me check ____ before we say ____.

Compare this wording: You're only here for a consultation.

Clearer: Today's booking shows a consultation. I understand you expected treatment, so let's check that difference with the dentist.

The revision names the mismatch without dismissing the patient's expectation.

4. Check the language

1. Patient: Is the filling definitely happening today?

Assistant: I can confirm a ____, but the procedure still needs clarification.

- A. procedure booking
- B. treatment-plan approval
- C. completed treatment
- D. consultation

2. Receptionist: Shall I tell the patient treatment is booked?

Assistant: Please ____ with the dentist first; the schedule only shows a discussion.

- A. check that
- B. assume that
- C. announce that
- D. guarantee that

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

I thought the treatment was today

At check-in, a patient and assistant discover different expectations.

01 • Patient: I took the morning off for my filling. Will the whole treatment fit into this appointment?

02 • Assistant: Today's schedule shows a thirty-minute consultation. I haven't confirmed a procedure for this visit.

03 • Patient: That's not what I understood when I called to make the booking last week.

04 • Assistant: I understand the difference matters. What were you told about the purpose of today's appointment?

05 • Patient: We discussed filling options, and I assumed that meant the filling would happen today.

06 • Assistant: Discussing options and booking treatment can be different steps. Let me clarify with the dentist.

07 • Patient: Please don't start anything until someone explains exactly what is planned and what isn't.

08 • Assistant: I'll pass that request on before the consultation begins and ask reception to check the booking note.

09 • Patient: Thank you. I would rather know the limits now than discover them halfway through the visit.

10 • Assistant: Agreed. I'll confirm the information we receive, without promising a procedure that hasn't been authorized.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Adding a concern to an existing slot

An assistant and receptionist coordinate a new question during a scheduled visit.

01 • Assistant: The patient booked a routine discussion but now wants the dentist to examine a separate concern.

02 • Receptionist: Can I simply add that to the same appointment slot and keep the original finish time?

03 • Assistant: I can't promise that. The dentist needs to decide what can appropriately be addressed during this visit.

04 • Receptionist: The patient is worried we will send them away without even hearing the new concern.

05 • Assistant: Please say we will pass it to the dental team, not that a particular procedure is guaranteed.

06 • Receptionist: Should I change the appointment type before the dentist has reviewed what the patient is asking?

07 • Assistant: Let's keep the confirmed booking separate from the request and ask for an authorized scheduling decision.

08 • Receptionist: I'll note that an additional concern was raised and that the appointment scope is awaiting clarification.

09 • Assistant: Good. The patient should hear the same explanation from both of us rather than two different promises.

10 • Receptionist: I'll confirm the outcome with you before I give the patient a revised finish-time estimate.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Which visit does the reminder refer to?

An assistant helps a patient distinguish two upcoming appointments.

01 • Patient: I received two reminders, and both say dental visit. Are they duplicates for the same appointment?

02 • Assistant: Let's check the dates and appointment types before treating either reminder as a duplicate.

03 • Patient: One is Tuesday at ten, and the other is the following Monday at three.

04 • Assistant: The Tuesday booking shows a consultation. I'll ask reception to confirm the purpose of Monday's booking.

05 • Patient: So I shouldn't cancel Monday just because both messages use the same general wording?

06 • Assistant: Correct. Similar reminder text doesn't establish that the appointments have the same purpose or requirements.

07 • Patient: Can you explain that to reception? I don't want an accidental cancellation to cause another delay.

08 • Assistant: I'll explain that you are asking for clarification, not requesting cancellation of either appointment.

09 • Patient: Please ask them to use the actual dates when they explain the difference to me.

10 • Assistant: I will. We'll confirm each visit separately so you know what is booked and what remains unclear.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Clarifying the appointment purpose

A fictional patient arrives expecting a filling today. The schedule shows a thirty-minute consultation, and no procedure is confirmed. The dentist can clarify the purpose before the patient decides whether to continue.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Patient: you took time off expecting a filling and remember discussing it by phone. You do not have a written procedure confirmation.

Second round: Reception finds a note saying 'discuss filling options.' Explain why that note does not by itself confirm that a filling will be performed.

Scenario 2 | A transport booking depends on the finish time

The patient needs to book a ride home. The schedule reserves thirty minutes for a consultation, but the dentist has not confirmed the likely finish time. Reception can give updates after clarification.

Role A: Assistant: distinguish the reserved slot from a guaranteed departure time.

Role B: Patient: you must tell the transport company when to collect you and can request a flexible pickup.

Possible opening: Can I promise the driver I'll be outside exactly thirty minutes after the appointment starts?

Success checks

- Explain what the appointment slot does and does not establish.
- Avoid guaranteeing a finish time outside your authority.
- Identify who can clarify timing and how the patient will receive an update.

Add a complication: The patient asks you to guarantee that no additional discussion will be needed.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Room readiness and safe clarification

Name the unresolved check and ask for an authorized pause or alternative.

SITUATION

A fictional instrument pack is present, but its required readiness documentation cannot be confirmed. The dentist is about to start. You are not authorized to waive the practice's checks. A verified replacement may be available through the lead assistant.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

operatory - The dental treatment room where patient care is provided.

instrument tray - The arranged set of instruments for a particular clinical task.

sterilization record - The required documentation used by the practice to verify an instrument-processing cycle.

turnover - The preparation of a room between patients under the practice's approved procedures.

Useful word combinations

confirm room readiness: verify the room's documented preparation status

flag a discrepancy: draw attention to a mismatch requiring a check

hold the setup: pause use while an unresolved readiness concern is checked

follow the approved protocol: use the practice's authorized procedure rather than improvising

LESSON 02 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Speak up before a readiness assumption becomes an action

3. Notice the language

A room can look tidy without every required readiness check being complete. This lesson practices escalation language, not sterilization methods. Describe the missing confirmation accurately; do not label equipment contaminated without evidence or bypass a required check.

Before we begin, I cannot confirm ____.

Could we hold ____ while ____ is checked?

The status is unverified, not confirmed as ____.

Compare this wording: It looks fine, so we can probably start.

Clearer: I cannot confirm the required record. Please hold this setup while the lead assistant checks the status.

Appearance does not replace the required confirmation, and the revised request identifies the action needed.

4. Check the language

1. Dentist: Is that pack ready for use?

Assistant: Its required record is ____, so I need the approved verification process.

A. irrelevant

B. unverified

C. unnecessary

D. complete

2. Lead assistant: What are you asking us to do while I check?

Assistant: Please ____ this setup until its status is confirmed.

A. sign off

B. hold

C. duplicate

D. dispatch

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The record is not confirmed

An assistant raises a readiness concern before the fictional appointment begins.

01 • Assistant: Before we begin, I need to flag a discrepancy with the required readiness record for this pack.

02 • Dentist: Is something visibly wrong with the pack, or is the concern about its documented status?

03 • Assistant: The concern is that I cannot confirm the required record. I'm not making a conclusion from its appearance.

04 • Dentist: What do you need us to do while that information is checked through the approved process?

05 • Assistant: Please hold this setup. The lead assistant can verify the status or identify a verified replacement.

06 • Dentist: All right. Let the lead assistant know the appointment is waiting, but don't bypass the required check.

07 • Assistant: I will. I'll explain the urgency without presenting it as permission to treat an unknown status as acceptable.

08 • Dentist: What should we tell the patient while the team resolves the readiness question?

09 • Assistant: We can say we are completing a required preparation check and will update them when the room is ready.

10 • Dentist: Good. Give a factual update without guessing how long the check will take or overstating the finding.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Ready for which appointment?

Two assistants clarify a room-status message before the next patient is brought in.

01 • Assistant: Your message says room two is ready. Does that include the setup for the next booked appointment?

02 • Lead assistant: It means the approved room turnover is complete. I haven't confirmed the procedure-specific setup yet.

03 • Assistant: Then I shouldn't describe the whole operatory as fully ready for that patient at this point.

04 • Lead assistant: Correct. We need to distinguish completed turnover from the remaining setup check for the scheduled care.

05 • Assistant: The dentist asked for a status update. I'll name the completed stage and the item still being checked.

06 • Lead assistant: Please do. A short message can still be precise if it identifies which kind of readiness it means.

07 • Assistant: Would you like me to confirm with you again before I tell reception to bring the patient through?

08 • Lead assistant: Yes. Use the practice's usual readiness process rather than assuming the earlier message covers the later check.

09 • Assistant: I'll report that turnover is complete and the final appointment setup remains pending confirmation.

10 • Lead assistant: Thank you. I'll give you a clear update when the authorized check is complete and the status changes.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A name on the tray list

An assistant clarifies a tray request rather than guessing between similar labels.

01 • Assistant: I heard you request the tray marked C, but there are two similar labels on today's list.

02 • Dentist: Thank you for checking. Which labels do you see, and what information is missing from my request?

03 • Assistant: One refers to the consultation setup and the other to a different procedure. I need the full description.

04 • Dentist: For this appointment, use the approved consultation setup after the usual readiness checks are complete.

05 • Assistant: Consultation setup for this appointment, subject to the normal checks. I won't substitute the other tray.

06 • Dentist: Exactly. If the labels remain confusing, ask the lead assistant to address the naming problem through our process.

07 • Assistant: I'll raise that separately so another worker doesn't have to infer the intended tray from an abbreviated request.

08 • Dentist: Good. Please keep the correction focused on the ambiguity, not on blaming whoever prepared the list.

09 • Assistant: I can say the labels are easily confused and suggest that the approved descriptions be made more distinct.

10 • Dentist: That would be useful. For now, your read-back has clarified the specific setup I meant for this visit.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Room readiness and safe clarification

A fictional instrument pack is present, but its required readiness documentation cannot be confirmed. The dentist is about to start. You are not authorized to waive the practice's checks. A verified replacement may be available through the lead assistant.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Dentist: you are ready to begin and need a concise statement of the unresolved issue and a workable authorized next step.

Second round: A colleague says the pack looks identical to a verified one. Explain why visual similarity does not answer the missing-record question.

Scenario 2 | A rushed room-status message

Reception asks whether room three is ready. Turnover is complete, but the appointment-specific setup check is still pending. The lead assistant expects an update in five minutes but has not approved room use.

Role A: Assistant: distinguish completed turnover from pending setup and request that reception wait for confirmation.

Role B: Receptionist: you want to reduce the patient's wait and thought 'cleaned' meant fully ready.

Possible opening: The room has been cleaned, so can I bring the patient in now?

Success checks

- Name the completed stage and the pending stage.
- Request a specific pause without claiming contamination or danger not established by the facts.
- Confirm who will communicate the final readiness status.

Add a complication: The next patient has arrived early. Their arrival does not change the required readiness process.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Chairside requests and read-backs

Identify the exact missing word or detail instead of silently guessing.

SITUATION

During a fictional setup briefing, you hear 'tray' but miss the rest because another conversation interrupts. The list includes both an instrument tray and an impression tray. You have not selected either. Ask which tray is intended and read back the request before continuing under the practice's procedures.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

chairside - At the patient's treatment chair, assisting the authorized clinician.

suction - Removal of fluid or material through approved dental equipment by authorized staff.

retraction - Holding tissue away from a working area as directed and permitted by the clinician.

read-back - Repeating a request or detail to confirm shared understanding.

Useful word combinations

repeat the full request: replace an unclear abbreviation with complete wording

confirm the intended item: identify the exact requested instrument or supply

ask for clarification: check meaning before carrying out an uncertain instruction

read the instruction back: repeat the understood request for confirmation

LESSON 03 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Make clarification brief and specific

3. Notice the language

A concise read-back is useful when names, numbers, or locations could be confused. This is communication practice, not instruction in using dental instruments. Ask about the uncertain part, repeat the answer, and let the clinician correct it.

I heard ___, but not ___. Could you repeat that part?

Do you mean ___ for this setup?

Let me read that back: ___.

Compare this wording: I think I know what you meant.

Clearer: I heard 'tray,' but not which kind. Did you mean the instrument tray or the impression tray?

The listener can repair a specific gap more easily than an unspecified uncertainty.

4. Check the language

1. Dentist: Did you hear the whole request?

Assistant: I heard the first word, but the item name was ___ by the other conversation.

- A. confirmed
- B. authorized
- C. obscured
- D. repeated

2. Dentist: I meant the impression tray, not the instrument tray.

Assistant: Let me ___: the impression tray for this setup.

- A. rule that out
- B. sign that off
- C. put that aside
- D. read that back

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The last word was lost

A noisy setup discussion makes an item name unclear.

01 • Assistant: I heard 'tray,' but not which kind. Could you repeat the full name for me?

02 • Dentist: The impression tray, please. I was looking at the second entry on our setup list.

03 • Assistant: The impression tray, not the instrument tray. Is that the one you meant for this appointment?

04 • Dentist: Yes, that's right. Both entries contain 'tray,' so my shortened request wasn't very helpful.

05 • Assistant: Thanks. I hadn't selected either because the conversation behind me covered the first word.

06 • Dentist: Please keep asking when you miss part of a request. I can repeat it.

07 • Assistant: Could we use the full names when both kinds appear on the same list?

08 • Dentist: Certainly. That should make the briefing clearer, especially while the next room is busy.

09 • Assistant: I'll mark the request as clarified. The usual preparation checks still need to be completed.

10 • Dentist: Agreed. Confirming the name doesn't mean the room is ready; please report that separately.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The fault belongs to operator two

An assistant and lead assistant clarify a suction-equipment report before a room is described as ready.

01 • Assistant: The chairside note names a suction issue in operator two, but the service ticket lists room three. Which location is correct?

02 • Lead assistant: Operator two is correct. Room three was copied from an earlier ticket; that location needs correcting.

03 • Assistant: Thank you. I haven't tested the equipment or identified a cause, so I'll keep this as a reported issue.

04 • Lead assistant: That's right. The equipment lead will assess it. Please give them the room number and the original report.

05 • Assistant: Should I update reception as well? Their room board currently shows operator two as ready.

06 • Lead assistant: Yes. Tell reception its readiness is under review, and ask them to acknowledge the changed status.

07 • Assistant: I'll say operator two, suction issue reported, assessment pending. I won't give an unsupported repair time.

08 • Lead assistant: Good. Keep room three separate; this report doesn't establish any fault or change of status there.

09 • Assistant: Understood. I'll correct the ticket through the usual process and read the location back to the equipment lead.

10 • Lead assistant: Then let me know they've received it, so I can coordinate the next room update with reception.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A request made too quickly

A trainee assistant requests a clearer pace during a room briefing.

01 • Assistant: Could you separate the two setup requests? I caught the first, but the second came too quickly.

02 • Lead assistant: Of course. Tell me which request you understood so I don't simply repeat both just as fast.

03 • Assistant: You asked me to check the approved list for room one. I missed what should happen afterward.

04 • Lead assistant: After that check, report any discrepancy to me before the team describes the room as ready.

05 • Assistant: So I check the list, report any mismatch, and wait for the authorized readiness confirmation.

06 • Lead assistant: Exactly. The instruction is a sequence, not permission to skip the check when the schedule is busy.

07 • Assistant: Thank you. I'm comfortable with the words; I needed the order made explicit.

08 • Lead assistant: That's helpful feedback. I'll pause between the stages when we brief a new or complex setup.

09 • Assistant: I'll also say specifically which step I missed rather than just asking you to repeat everything.

10 • Lead assistant: Good. Clear questions and clear read-backs make the whole team less dependent on assumptions.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Chairside requests and read-backs

During a fictional setup briefing, you hear 'tray' but miss the rest because another conversation interrupts. The list includes both an instrument tray and an impression tray. You have not selected either. Ask which tray is intended and read back the request before continuing under the practice's procedures.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Dentist: you intended the impression tray, not the instrument tray. Confirm that full name when asked; do not introduce clinical use instructions.

Second round: The dentist uses 'that one' while looking away. Ask for an explicit description rather than relying on a direction you cannot see.

Scenario 2 | An unfamiliar room abbreviation

At this fictional practice, a message says 'check OP4.' You do not know the local abbreviation. The lead assistant means checking the setup list for operator four, not declaring the room ready. No readiness check has been completed.

Role A: Assistant: ask what OP4 means and clarify which check is requested.

Role B: Lead assistant: in this practice OP means operator. You need the setup list checked for operator four; report any missing information to you.

Possible opening: Could you check OP4 before our room briefing?

Success checks

- Ask for the abbreviation to be expanded without guessing.
- Read back the room number and the requested check.
- Distinguish checking a list from confirming overall room readiness.

Add a complication: A second message mentions OP2. It concerns a separate appointment; clarify which room belongs to the current request.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Imaging questions and authorization

Respond to an imaging question by identifying the right decision-maker and preserving the patient's question.

SITUATION

A fictional patient asks whether an image proves that a tooth needs treatment. You are assisting with the visit and are not authorized to interpret the image. The dentist has not yet discussed it with the patient.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

radiograph - A dental X-ray image interpreted by an appropriately qualified professional.

imaging order - The authorized request specifying the imaging needed for a patient.

retake - A repeat image, which requires the practice's applicable clinical decision and authorization.

authorization - Permission from the appropriate person or process to carry out a specified task.

Useful word combinations

confirm the imaging order: verify the current authorized request

refer an interpretation question: direct questions about an image to the clinician

explain the next step: describe the communication process without inventing clinical advice

request clarification before proceeding: obtain missing authority or detail before acting

LESSON 04 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Explain your role without interpreting the image

3. Notice the language

Recognizing the word 'radiograph' does not qualify someone to interpret an image. Nor does being asked for a retake establish authority to perform it. This lesson covers communication only; follow local requirements and the current authorized order.

The clinician needs to interpret ___ before explaining ___.

I can help communicate your question, but I cannot decide ___.

Could you confirm the current order and authorization for ___?

Compare this wording: That dark area definitely means you need treatment.

Clearer: The dentist will need to interpret that area and explain whether it affects your care.

The revised wording avoids an unauthorized diagnosis or treatment conclusion.

4. Check the language

1. Patient: The radiograph has been taken and saved. Who can explain what it means for my tooth?

Assistant: I'll ask the dentist to ___ the image with you.

- A. retake
- B. interpret
- C. retrieve
- D. duplicate

2. Colleague: Someone mentioned another image. Is that enough to proceed?

Assistant: We need to confirm the current imaging ___ and our authority first.

- A. estimate
- B. reminder
- C. order
- D. caption

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Does the image prove it?

A patient asks an assistant for a clinical interpretation.

01 • Patient: Does that image prove I need treatment, or is the dentist still deciding what it means?

02 • Assistant: The dentist needs to interpret it and explain its meaning for your care. I can't make that determination.

03 • Patient: I can see a darker area, and I thought you might be able to tell me what it is.

04 • Assistant: I understand the question, but appearance alone isn't something I should interpret for you outside my authorized role.

05 • Patient: Can you make sure the dentist knows I want an explanation before I agree to anything?

06 • Assistant: Yes. I'll pass on that exact request rather than treating your question as agreement to a procedure.

07 • Patient: Thank you. I don't want to feel that the decision has already been made without a discussion.

08 • Assistant: I'll help make space for that discussion and identify the question you want answered first.

09 • Patient: Please also tell the dentist that I want the explanation in everyday words, not just technical names.

10 • Assistant: I will. You can ask about any term that remains unclear when the clinician explains the findings.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A possible retake is not an order

An assistant clarifies a passing comment about imaging.

01 • Assistant: I heard a comment that another image might be needed. Has an authorized imaging request actually been made?

02 • Dentist: Not yet. I was considering the information available and still need to decide the appropriate next step.

03 • Assistant: Then I will not treat that comment as an instruction to proceed with a retake.

04 • Dentist: Correct. Please keep the current status clear and follow the practice's authorization process for any imaging task.

05 • Assistant: The patient asked whether another image is definitely planned. What should I say at this stage?

06 • Dentist: Say that the clinician is reviewing the information and has not yet confirmed another image.

07 • Assistant: I'll distinguish consideration from a confirmed request, without giving a technical justification you haven't provided.

08 • Dentist: Thank you. If the order changes, we will communicate the authorized details through the usual process.

09 • Assistant: I'll also check that the task is within my permitted duties before taking any action.

10 • Dentist: Good. A clear order and the worker's authority are separate checks, and both matter.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Explaining a word, not a finding

A patient asks about terminology on an appointment note.

01 • Patient: The note says radiograph. Is that a different kind of appointment from the X-ray we discussed?

02 • Assistant: Radiograph means an X-ray image. I can explain that word, but I need to check the actual booking.

03 • Patient: So knowing the word doesn't tell us whether an image is definitely scheduled for this visit?

04 • Assistant: That's right. The appointment details and any current imaging order need separate confirmation through the practice.

05 • Patient: Could you check those before I assume this reminder means the plan has changed?

06 • Assistant: Yes. I'll ask the authorized team to clarify the visit and pass on your question accurately.

07 • Patient: I also have a question about why an image might be needed in my case.

08 • Assistant: That explanation should come from the dentist or other appropriately authorized clinician who knows the request.

09 • Patient: Please ask them to explain the reason rather than just tell me that it is routine.

10 • Assistant: I will. I'll distinguish your question about the word from your clinical question about the reason.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Imaging questions and authorization

A fictional patient asks whether an image proves that a tooth needs treatment. You are assisting with the visit and are not authorized to interpret the image. The dentist has not yet discussed it with the patient.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Patient: you want to understand the image and do not want staff to make assumptions about your agreement to treatment.

Second round: The patient says another assistant once explained a similar image. Keep the boundary about your own role without criticizing that person.

Scenario 2 | A copied order description

A colleague suggests copying an imaging description from a previous visit into today's setup message. Today's authorized order has not yet been verified. You do not know whether the earlier description still applies.

Role A: Assistant: explain why a previous entry cannot substitute for a current authorized request.

Role B: Colleague: you want to save time, but can ask the dentist to confirm today's order.

Possible opening: Can we use the same imaging description as last time to get the room moving?

Success checks

- Distinguish historical information from a current order.
- Ask the authorized person for the current request.
- Avoid advising on whether imaging is clinically necessary.

Add a complication: The patient remembers the earlier image too, but that memory does not establish today's request.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Patient comfort, questions, and pauses

Acknowledge the concern and obtain a clinician-led explanation before a decision.

SITUATION

A fictional patient is anxious and asks you to promise a procedure will not hurt. The dentist has not yet discussed comfort measures or the patient's concerns. You can help communicate the concern and ask the clinician to explain the plan and an appropriate pause signal.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

patient concern - A worry or question the patient wants the dental team to address.

pause signal - An agreed way for a patient to indicate that they want the clinician's attention or a pause.

informed consent - A properly supported decision about care following the required explanation and opportunity for questions.

reassurance - Supportive language that acknowledges worry without guaranteeing comfort or outcomes.

Useful word combinations

acknowledge anxiety: recognize a patient's worry without dismissing it

agree a pause signal: establish how the patient can communicate during care under the clinician's guidance

invite a question: give the patient room to ask about an unclear point

avoid a blanket promise: do not guarantee that an individual experience will be painless or problem-free

LESSON 05 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Reassure without guaranteeing an experience

3. Notice the language

'Don't worry' can sound dismissive when a patient has a specific concern. Name the concern, be honest about what you cannot promise, and support the patient's opportunity to ask the authorized professional. This exercise does not teach consent law or pain management.

I hear that you're worried about ____.

I can't promise ____, but I can help you ask ____.

Before we begin, let's clarify ____ with the clinician.

Compare this wording: Don't worry. You won't feel a thing.

Clearer: I hear that you are concerned about discomfort. Let's ask the dentist to explain what to expect and how to signal a concern.

The revised reassurance offers a practical next step without predicting the patient's experience.

4. Check the language

1. Patient: Can you guarantee it won't hurt?

Assistant: I can't ____ your experience, but I can help you raise the concern with the dentist.

- A. acknowledge
- B. listen to
- C. guarantee
- D. describe your question about

2. Patient: I don't understand the alternatives yet, so I haven't decided.

Assistant: I'll tell the dentist you need further ____ before making that decision.

- A. confirmation that treatment is complete
- B. consent
- C. reassurance that you already agreed
- D. explanation

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A promise the assistant cannot make

An anxious patient asks about comfort before the clinician explains the proposed care.

01 • Patient: Please promise me it won't hurt. I had a bad experience at another practice last year.

02 • Assistant: I'm sorry that experience has made this visit worrying. I can't promise exactly how this procedure would feel.

03 • Patient: That's an honest answer, but I still need to know how I can get someone's attention.

04 • Assistant: Let's ask the dentist to explain the comfort plan and agree on a pause signal you can use.

05 • Patient: Will the team be annoyed if I need to ask for that more than once?

06 • Assistant: Your concern deserves to be discussed. I'll tell the dentist that a clear communication plan would help you.

07 • Patient: I also want the explanation before anyone assumes that I'm ready to begin the procedure.

08 • Assistant: I'll make that request clear. Asking a question should not be treated as agreement to start.

09 • Patient: Thank you. I would rather understand the plan than hear a quick promise that might not be true.

10 • Assistant: I'll bring the dentist into the discussion so your specific questions can be answered by the right person.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A question behind the silence

An assistant checks whether a quiet patient has an unresolved concern.

01 • Assistant: Before I pass the information to the dentist, is there a question you still want them to address?

02 • Patient: I'm not sure how to ask it. Everyone seems busy, and I don't want to slow the appointment.

03 • Assistant: We can make time to identify the question. What part of the explanation is still unclear to you?

04 • Patient: I saw a crown on the treatment plan, but I don't understand why it's proposed instead of another option.

05 • Assistant: That's a question for the dentist to explain. May I tell them you want a comparison of the options?

06 • Patient: Yes, please. My silence didn't mean that I had understood the difference or agreed to the plan.

07 • Assistant: I'll make that distinction. I won't describe you as ready to proceed when you are still asking for information.

08 • Patient: Thank you. Could they use everyday words and check that I understand the important points?

09 • Assistant: I'll pass on that preference along with the question about the alternatives and their reasons.

10 • Patient: That would help. I want to participate in the decision, not simply nod because the words are unfamiliar.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The companion answers for the patient

An assistant protects space for the patient's own question.

01 • Companion: She is nervous, but she'll agree once you get started. You can tell the dentist to go ahead.

02 • Assistant: I can't treat that statement as the patient's decision. We need to hear her own questions and preferences.

03 • Companion: I'm only trying to help because she finds it difficult to speak when she's anxious.

04 • Assistant: Your support may be useful if she wants it. Let's give her time and ask how she would like you involved.

05 • Companion: Would it help if I explain what she told me on the way to the appointment?

06 • Assistant: You can offer that information with her agreement, while the clinician checks the decision through the appropriate process.

07 • Companion: I don't want my confidence to make it seem that she has already agreed when she hasn't said so.

08 • Assistant: Exactly. We can support the conversation without replacing her own voice or the clinician's explanation.

09 • Companion: I'll ask whether she wants me to help explain the concern, then let her answer the dentist.

10 • Assistant: Thank you. I'll tell the dentist that she may need a slower discussion and time for questions before deciding.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Patient comfort, questions, and pauses

A fictional patient is anxious and asks you to promise a procedure will not hurt. The dentist has not yet discussed comfort measures or the patient's concerns. You can help communicate the concern and ask the clinician to explain the plan and an appropriate pause signal.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Patient: you had an uncomfortable experience elsewhere and want an honest explanation before deciding. You have not agreed to the proposed procedure.

Second round: The patient asks whether asking for a pause will annoy the team. Support the question and ask the clinician to establish the communication plan.

Scenario 2 | A question after the explanation

The dentist has explained a proposed procedure, but the patient tells you they still do not understand one term. No decision is established by this scenario. You can ask the dentist to revisit the explanation.

Role A: Assistant: acknowledge the unresolved term and help the patient obtain clarification.

Role B: Patient: you nodded because you felt embarrassed, not because you understood.

Possible opening: I nodded earlier, but I don't actually know what that term means for me.

Success checks

- Distinguish hearing an explanation from understanding it.
- Avoid labeling the patient's earlier nod as a decision.
- Bring the specific question back to the authorized clinician.

Add a complication: A colleague says the explanation has already been given. You still need to communicate that understanding remains unresolved.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Records, identifiers, and factual handoffs

Identify conflicting sources and obtain an authorized record check.

SITUATION

Two fictional patients share a surname. The appointment list and a folder label contain a mismatch in another identifier. You have not used the folder. The lead assistant can check the records through the approved process.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

patient identifier - A verified detail used under the practice's procedure to distinguish one patient from another.

clinical chart - The authorized record of a patient's dental information and care.

discrepancy - A mismatch between two pieces of information that requires clarification.

amendment - A documented correction or addition made through the approved record process.

Useful word combinations

verify the identifiers: use the approved identity-check procedure

flag a chart discrepancy: raise a mismatch without silently choosing one version

make an authorized amendment: correct a record using the permitted process

attribute the statement: identify who supplied a piece of information

LESSON 06 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Report a mismatch without silently correcting it

3. Notice the language

A familiar surname does not resolve a mismatch. Keep the versions distinct, protect private details, and use the approved correction process. Practice with fictional identifiers only.

The ___ shows ___, while the ___ shows ___.

I have not treated either version as confirmed.

Could the authorized person verify ___ before we proceed?

Compare this wording: The surname matches, so it must be the right folder.

Clearer: The surname matches, but another identifier differs. We need the approved check before using the folder.

One matching detail does not resolve conflicting information.

4. Check the language

1. Assistant: These records share a surname but differ on another identifier.

Lead assistant: That is a ___ requiring verification.

A. completed amendment

B. confirmation

C. preference

D. discrepancy

2. Assistant: The earlier finalized entry is inaccurate.

Lead assistant: Use the approved ___ process rather than silently replacing it.

A. amendment

B. booking

C. dispatch

D. turnover

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The surname matches, but the record does not

An assistant reports a discrepancy before a folder is used.

01 • Assistant: I need an identity check before this folder is used. The surname matches, but another patient identifier differs.

02 • Lead assistant: Which two sources are you comparing, and has the folder already been used during today's appointment?

03 • Assistant: I'm comparing the appointment list with the folder label. I have held the folder and haven't used it.

04 • Lead assistant: Two patients share that surname, so we need the approved verification process rather than a guess.

05 • Assistant: A colleague recognizes the patient from last month. I don't think that resolves the document mismatch itself.

06 • Lead assistant: It doesn't. Recognition may be additional context, but the conflicting records still need the authorized check.

07 • Assistant: I'll keep the details within the approved private channel and avoid discussing them across the waiting room.

08 • Lead assistant: Please describe the discrepancy precisely without deciding which version is wrong before it is verified.

09 • Assistant: Once the correct record is confirmed, who will handle any necessary amendment to the inaccurate entry?

10 • Lead assistant: The authorized records process will determine that. I'll confirm the outcome before the team proceeds with the folder.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Whose words are in the note?

A chart phrase may be an interpretation rather than a quotation.

01 • Lead assistant: The note says the patient refused to discuss the plan. Did they actually use those words during the visit?

02 • Assistant: No. They said they needed more time to understand one term. My wording interpreted that as refusal.

03 • Lead assistant: Those meanings differ. We need a factual amendment through the approved process so the next clinician understands the request.

04 • Assistant: I can identify the actual statement and explain that my earlier phrase was an interpretation, not a direct quotation.

05 • Lead assistant: Please also clarify whether a final decision was made, rather than letting the corrected note imply one.

06 • Assistant: No final decision was established. The patient asked for another explanation before deciding about the proposed care.

07 • Lead assistant: Then preserve that uncertainty. An unresolved question is not automatically agreement, refusal, or unwillingness to cooperate.

08 • Assistant: I'll use neutral wording and alert the authorized team so the earlier phrase doesn't keep circulating.

09 • Lead assistant: What will you say in the handoff to the dentist who is seeing the patient next?

10 • Assistant: The patient requested clarification before deciding, and the earlier refusal wording has been referred for amendment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A private record in a public space

An assistant redirects a records discussion away from a reception queue.

01 • Receptionist: Can you confirm details from this patient's chart while I have the next three people waiting here?

02 • Assistant: Let's use the approved private channel. We shouldn't discuss unnecessary patient details where other visitors can hear.

03 • Receptionist: I only need to know whether the record mismatch is resolved before I update the appointment status.

04 • Assistant: The authorized check is still pending. I can confirm that without repeating the private identifiers in the queue.

05 • Receptionist: Then I should leave the status pending rather than mark it verified just to keep the line moving.

06 • Assistant: Correct. The number of people waiting doesn't establish that the conflicting information has been checked.

07 • Receptionist: Who should I contact for a time estimate for the next update to the patient?

08 • Assistant: The lead assistant is handling the check. Please ask them through the usual communication route.

09 • Receptionist: I'll explain the administrative delay without sharing another person's details or suggesting that the patient caused it.

10 • Assistant: Thank you. A useful status update can still limit disclosure to information appropriate to the purpose.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Records, identifiers, and factual handoffs

Two fictional patients share a surname. The appointment list and a folder label contain a mismatch in another identifier. You have not used the folder. The lead assistant can check the records through the approved process.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Lead assistant: ask which records conflict and whether the folder has been used; initiate the approved check.

Second round: A colleague recognizes the patient from a previous visit. Explain why recognition does not remove the record mismatch.

Scenario 2 | A copied note with the wrong date

A draft handoff includes a previous visit's date. Today's date is verified, but you cannot silently overwrite finalized entries. The records lead handles corrections.

Role A: Assistant: flag the discrepancy and ask whether the entry is finalized.

Role B: Records lead: determine the entry's status and direct the approved correction process.

Possible opening: This handoff appears to include the previous visit's date; can we check its status before use?

Success checks

- Name the mismatch and its source.
- Do not hide or silently overwrite a finalized record.
- Confirm the correction route and notify the appropriate recipient.

Add a complication: A colleague asks you to erase the old entry so nobody sees the mistake.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Laboratory cases and delivery expectations

Link a delivery risk to a concrete update time and authorized scheduling decision.

SITUATION

A fictional laboratory estimates a case will arrive Tuesday by noon; the patient's appointment is at 14:00. Delivery is not guaranteed, and the dentist must confirm readiness before the appointment proceeds. The lab can provide a status update Monday at 16:00.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

laboratory prescription - The authorized clinician's instructions to a dental laboratory for a specific case.

impression - A representation of oral structures supplied under authorized clinical procedures for a dental case.

shade - The specified color designation used in matching a dental restoration.

turnaround time - The expected interval between receiving a laboratory case and completing or returning the work.

Useful word combinations

confirm the case reference: check which laboratory job is being discussed

query the specification: ask about an unclear authorized instruction

quote a turnaround estimate: state expected timing without treating it as guaranteed

flag a delivery risk: explain why an expected arrival may affect an appointment

LESSON 07 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Negotiate an update, not an impossible guarantee

3. Notice the language

Laboratory dispatch, delivery, and clinical readiness are different stages. An assistant can coordinate information without changing the prescription, choosing a shade, or promising that a restoration will be suitable before the clinician checks it.

The current estimate is ____; the appointment is ____.

Could you confirm ____ by ____ so the team can decide ____?

Receipt does not yet confirm ____.

Compare this wording: The lab says noon, so the two o'clock appointment is guaranteed.

Clearer: Noon is a delivery estimate. The team still needs to confirm arrival and clinical readiness before confirming the appointment plan.

The revision separates logistics from an authorized clinical readiness decision.

4. Check the language

1. Lab: We expect delivery at noon, but it is not guaranteed.

Assistant: I'll describe that as a turnaround ____, not a confirmed arrival.

A. authorization

B. prescription

C. estimate

D. shade

2. Lab: The shade instruction is unclear. Who can clarify the clinical specification?

Assistant: That clarification must come from the ____ who issued the prescription.

A. authorized clinician

B. appointment coordinator

C. purchasing assistant

D. laboratory courier

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Noon is an estimate

An assistant and laboratory coordinator discuss a tight delivery window.

01 • Assistant: The patient is booked Tuesday at two. Your current delivery estimate is noon, leaving a tight window.

02 • Lab coordinator: That's our estimate, but it isn't guaranteed. The case also needs the practice's checks after it arrives.

03 • Assistant: Then I can't tell reception that the appointment is secured simply because delivery is expected before two.

04 • Lab coordinator: Correct. We can update the case status Monday at four so your team has better information.

05 • Assistant: Could that update distinguish production completion, dispatch, and expected delivery rather than just saying it is on track?

06 • Lab coordinator: Yes. I'll report the actual stage and flag anything that changes the current delivery expectation.

07 • Assistant: The dentist will need to make the readiness decision, and reception will confirm any scheduling changes.

08 • Lab coordinator: Understood. We won't describe our dispatch confirmation as a clinical sign-off for the patient's appointment.

09 • Assistant: I'll tell the team when to expect your update and keep the current arrival time labeled as an estimate.

10 • Lab coordinator: I'll contact you Monday at four even if the status is unresolved, so you aren't left waiting without information.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An unclear shade instruction

A laboratory query requires the clinician's clarification rather than an assistant's guess.

01 • Lab coordinator: The shade entry on the prescription is unclear. Can you tell us which of these two readings is intended?

02 • Assistant: I can see the ambiguity, but I am not authorized to choose the specification on the clinician's behalf.

03 • Lab coordinator: Could you ask the clinician to clarify it through the approved channel using this case reference?

04 • Assistant: Yes. I'll pass on both possible readings and make clear that the laboratory hasn't received a confirmed answer.

05 • Lab coordinator: Please don't send the more likely reading as though it were the authorized instruction for production.

06 • Assistant: I won't. I'll distinguish my transcription question from the clinician's actual specification and request a verified response.

07 • Lab coordinator: We can hold the affected stage while the query is resolved, but it may change the turnaround time.

08 • Assistant: Please state that timing risk in the update so the practice can review the appointment plan.

09 • Lab coordinator: I'll do that. Let us know when the authorized clarification has been received, not just requested.

10 • Assistant: Agreed. I'll confirm receipt and ask you to read back the clarified specification through the practice's approved process.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Delivered is not clinically approved

An assistant explains the status of a returned laboratory case to reception.

01 • Receptionist: The parcel has arrived, so can I tell the patient everything is ready for the appointment?

02 • Assistant: Arrival is confirmed, but the dentist's required check has not yet been completed for this case.

03 • Receptionist: I thought delivery meant the laboratory had finished the work and there was nothing else to confirm.

04 • Assistant: It confirms a logistics stage. It doesn't replace the practice's identification and clinical readiness checks.

05 • Receptionist: Should I leave the appointment status unchanged until the authorized team gives me a clear update?

06 • Assistant: Please follow our usual process and wait for that confirmation before promising readiness to the patient.

07 • Receptionist: The patient is asking whether to leave home. Who should give the next timing update?

08 • Assistant: The lead assistant is coordinating the check with the dentist and can provide the verified status.

09 • Receptionist: I'll explain that the case has arrived and the final check is pending, without suggesting a problem was found.

10 • Assistant: That's accurate. Pending verification is not the same as a confirmed defect, and we should not imply either outcome.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Laboratory cases and delivery expectations

A fictional laboratory estimates a case will arrive Tuesday by noon; the patient's appointment is at 14:00. Delivery is not guaranteed, and the dentist must confirm readiness before the appointment proceeds. The lab can provide a status update Monday at 16:00.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Laboratory coordinator: noon Tuesday is an estimate, and you can commit to an update Monday at 16:00, not to guaranteed delivery.

Second round: Reception asks whether dispatch means the case is ready for the patient. Explain the remaining delivery and clinical checks.

Scenario 2 | A second parcel with a similar reference

Two lab parcels arrive with similar case references. One patient is due at 14:00. The identifiers on one parcel need clarification, and the authorized team has not approved either case for use.

Role A: Assistant: ask the lab to verify the reference through the approved private channel.

Role B: Lab coordinator: you can check dispatch records but cannot make the dentist's clinical readiness decision.

Possible opening: Before we associate this parcel with today's appointment, can you confirm the full case reference?

Success checks

- Verify the specific case instead of assuming from timing.
- Protect private identifiers during the query.
- Keep receipt, identity verification, and clinical approval distinct.

Add a complication: Reception wants to rely on the expected arrival date because the patient is on the way.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Aftercare questions and follow-up calls

Identify the unclear instruction and obtain an appropriate authorized response.

SITUATION

A fictional patient calls with an unclear phrase in their written postoperative instructions. You are not authorized to reinterpret or change those instructions. The clinician can answer through the practice's callback process. If the caller reports an urgent or emergency concern, use the designated route rather than an ordinary queue.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

postoperative instructions - The authorized guidance given after a dental procedure, which staff must not improvise or change.

review appointment - A planned follow-up visit for the clinician to assess or discuss care.

callback - A return contact arranged to respond to a patient's question or request.

urgent concern - A time-sensitive issue that must follow the practice's designated urgent or emergency route.

Useful word combinations

clarify the instructions: obtain an authorized explanation of unclear aftercare guidance

route the question: send it to the appropriate professional or response pathway

confirm the callback window: state the agreed period for a return contact

avoid reassurance beyond the evidence: do not label a reported problem harmless without authority

LESSON 08 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Route the question without inventing aftercare advice

3. Notice the language

This is language practice, not symptom assessment or treatment guidance. Do not recommend doses, label symptoms normal, or promise a response time that has not been agreed. Use the practice's screening and escalation procedures; do not substitute this lesson for them.

Which phrase in the instructions needs clarification?

I can relay ___, but the clinician needs to advise on ___.

The agreed callback window is ___; for an urgent concern, use ___.

Compare this wording: That sounds normal. Just follow what you remember.

Clearer: I cannot assess that concern or reconstruct the instructions from memory. Let's use the practice's appropriate response route.

The revision avoids unsupported reassurance and guessing at clinical guidance.

4. Check the language

1. Patient: Can you change what these postoperative instructions say?

Assistant: That needs an ___ response from the clinician.

A. authorized

B. informal

C. unrecorded

D. estimated

2. Patient: Is the promised call time also my review appointment?

Assistant: No. A ___ is a return contact; the appointment is a separate booking.

A. referral

B. recall interval

C. callback

D. review appointment

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The written phrase is unclear

A fictional aftercare sheet says 'resume your usual routine.' No interpretation is supplied. The patient has a wording question, and no urgent concern has been reported.

01 • Patient: The sheet says resume your usual routine. Does that mean returning to work, or does it include exercise too?

02 • Assistant: You want to know what usual routine includes, particularly work and exercise. Have I understood your question?

03 • Patient: Yes. I don't want you to change the instructions; I need the clinician to explain that phrase.

04 • Assistant: I'll pass on that exact wording and both examples. I haven't confirmed what the clinician intended it to cover.

05 • Patient: Could they call the number already in my record? I won't be able to answer between one and two.

06 • Assistant: I'll include that availability. Have you requested a call about this sheet already, or is this the first contact?

07 • Patient: This is the first call. I was wondering whether I'd need another appointment just to ask.

08 • Assistant: A callback request isn't an appointment booking. I'll check the response arrangements and confirm what the team agrees.

09 • Patient: Thank you. Please tell them I'm asking about the phrase on the sheet, not reporting a new symptom.

10 • Assistant: I'll keep that distinction in the message and ask who will respond. I don't have a confirmed callback time yet.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An overdue callback

An assistant follows up on an unanswered patient question.

01 • Assistant: The patient says the agreed callback window has passed without contact. I need to follow up through our approved process.

02 • Lead assistant: Has the patient reported a new concern, or are they asking about the unanswered question already sent to the clinician?

03 • Assistant: They are asking about the same unclear instruction. I haven't interpreted the delay as a judgment about its importance.

04 • Lead assistant: Good. A missed communication commitment doesn't tell us whether a clinical concern is significant or not.

05 • Assistant: Who owns the next contact? I don't want to promise another time without an authorized commitment from the team.

06 • Lead assistant: I'll check with the clinician and confirm the appropriate response route and next update through our usual process.

07 • Assistant: I'll tell the patient the callback is being followed up, not that their question has been clinically assessed as unimportant.

08 • Lead assistant: Exactly. If an urgent concern is reported, use the designated urgent pathway rather than leaving it in an ordinary queue.

09 • Assistant: I'll follow the screening procedure and report the caller's actual words without making my own clinical assessment.

10 • Lead assistant: Thank you. Once the next contact is confirmed, communicate it clearly and check that the patient understands the arrangement.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Review visit or phone contact?

A patient checks two different follow-up arrangements.

01 • Patient: My reminder shows a review appointment next week, but someone also mentioned calling me tomorrow. Are those the same arrangement?

02 • Assistant: A callback and a review appointment are different. Let's verify which contacts have actually been booked or agreed.

03 • Patient: I don't want to cancel next week's visit just because I expect a phone conversation tomorrow.

04 • Assistant: That's sensible. The phone contact doesn't automatically replace the review appointment unless the authorized team confirms a change.

05 • Patient: Can you check the exact date and purpose of the review while you confirm the callback arrangement?

06 • Assistant: Yes. I'll ask reception and the clinical team to clarify each item through the approved process.

07 • Patient: Please also tell them I have a question for the clinician, rather than writing that I want to stop follow-up care.

08 • Assistant: I'll preserve that distinction. Asking about the arrangements isn't the same as asking to cancel or decline care.

09 • Patient: Thank you. I need one clear explanation of what happens tomorrow and what remains scheduled for next week.

10 • Assistant: I'll report the verified details separately and identify anything that is still awaiting confirmation before you make plans.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Aftercare questions and follow-up calls

A fictional patient calls with an unclear phrase in their written postoperative instructions. You are not authorized to reinterpret or change those instructions. The clinician can answer through the practice's callback process. If the caller reports an urgent or emergency concern, use the designated route rather than an ordinary queue.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Patient: one phrase in your written instructions is unclear. You want a clinician's explanation and have not asked the assistant to diagnose anything.

Second round: The patient asks whether a missed callback means the question is unimportant. Explain that a communication delay does not establish clinical importance and use the appropriate follow-up route.

Scenario 2 | Advice remembered from a previous procedure

The patient asks whether instructions from an earlier procedure can replace the current written guidance. You have not verified any equivalence and are not authorized to change instructions. The appropriate clinician can clarify through the designated process.

Role A: Assistant: explain why prior guidance cannot simply be assumed to apply.

Role B: Patient: you remember the earlier wording more clearly and want to know which guidance is current.

Possible opening: Last time the instructions were different. Should I just follow the old ones again?

Success checks

- Distinguish previous instructions from current guidance.
- Do not choose, reinterpret, or invent clinical advice.
- Route the question using the appropriate regular or urgent process.

Add a complication: The patient asks you to choose the most convenient version before the clinician responds.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Clarifying the appointment purpose

Editing example: Today's booking shows a consultation. I understand you expected treatment, so let's check that difference with the dentist.

The revision names the mismatch without dismissing the patient's expectation.

Check 1: D - consultation

A: The schedule confirms a discussion, not a booked procedure.

B: An appointment entry does not establish the patient's approval of a treatment plan.

C: No treatment has been completed.

D: Correct. The schedule confirms the consultation only.

Check 2: A - check that

A: Correct. An open check resolves the mismatch without promising treatment.

B: An assumption would not resolve the mismatch.

C: Announcing treatment before checking would overstate the booking.

D: A guarantee is not supported by the schedule.

Model response: I see a thirty-minute consultation on today's schedule, but you were expecting a filling. I have not confirmed a procedure for this visit. Let me check with the dentist and reception before we describe what will happen today. Please tell us what you understood from the earlier booking conversation.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Room readiness and safe clarification

Editing example: I cannot confirm the required record. Please hold this setup while the lead assistant checks the status.

Appearance does not replace the required confirmation, and the revised request identifies the action needed.

Check 1: B - unverified

A: The record matters to readiness in this scenario.

B: Correct. This accurately states the missing confirmation.

C: The scenario explicitly requires the check.

D: Completion has not been established.

Check 2: B - hold

A: Signing off would indicate approval, which is not available.

B: Correct. 'Hold' asks for a pause pending confirmation.

C: Duplicating the setup does not resolve this status question.

D: Dispatching means sending something elsewhere, not pausing use.

Model response: Before we start, I need to flag a readiness discrepancy. I cannot confirm the required record for this pack, so I am not treating it as ready for use. Could we hold this setup while the lead assistant follows the approved verification process or provides a verified replacement? I will report the status as soon as it is confirmed.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Chairside requests and read-backs

Editing example: I heard 'tray,' but not which kind. Did you mean the instrument tray or the impression tray?

The listener can repair a specific gap more easily than an unspecified uncertainty.

Check 1: C - obscured

A: The assistant did not confirm the name.

B: Authorization does not describe a word that could not be heard.

C: Correct. 'Obscured' means it was made unclear or difficult to hear.

D: The item name has not yet been repeated.

Check 2: D - read that back

A: Ruling it out would reject the clarified request.

B: Signing off indicates approval, not a comprehension check.

C: Putting it aside would defer the issue rather than verify it.

D: Correct. Repeating the detail checks shared understanding.

Model response: I heard 'tray,' but I missed which kind because of the other conversation. The list includes both an instrument tray and an impression tray. Which one did you mean? I'll repeat the full name to check that I have understood before continuing with the setup.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Imaging questions and authorization

Editing example: The dentist will need to interpret that area and explain whether it affects your care.

The revised wording avoids an unauthorized diagnosis or treatment conclusion.

Check 1: B - interpret

A: Retaking produces a new image, which the patient's question does not request.

B: Correct. Interpreting the image belongs with the qualified clinician.

C: Retrieving accesses a saved image; the patient is asking for its interpretation.

D: Duplicating creates another copy; it does not explain the image's clinical meaning.

Check 2: C - order

A: An estimate does not establish the requested clinical task.

B: A reminder may prompt a check but is not an imaging order.

C: Correct. The authorized order identifies the requested imaging.

D: A caption describes an image but is not authorization.

Model response: The dentist needs to interpret the image and explain what it means for your care. I am not authorized to tell you whether it proves treatment is needed. I can let the dentist know you want that question answered before any decision is made, and help make sure you have an opportunity to ask it.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Patient comfort, questions, and pauses

Editing example: I hear that you are concerned about discomfort. Let's ask the dentist to explain what to expect and how to signal a concern.

The revised reassurance offers a practical next step without predicting the patient's experience.

Check 1: C - guarantee

A: The assistant can acknowledge the concern and experience.

B: Listening is available and should not be denied in this context.

C: Correct. The assistant cannot guarantee an individual experience.

D: The assistant can describe the patient's question accurately; that is not the missing limit here.

Check 2: D - explanation

A: Treatment completion is not established and would not explain the alternatives.

B: Consent is the patient's agreement; the missing step here is understanding the alternatives.

C: The patient explicitly says no decision has been made.

D: Correct. The patient is asking to understand more before deciding.

Model response: I understand you are worried about discomfort. I cannot promise exactly how a procedure will feel for you. Before anything begins, let's ask the dentist to explain the comfort plan and how you can signal if you need attention or a pause. I will make sure your concern is passed on clearly.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Records, identifiers, and factual handoffs

Editing example: The surname matches, but another identifier differs. We need the approved check before using the folder.

One matching detail does not resolve conflicting information.

Check 1: D - discrepancy

A: No correction has yet been made.

B: The conflicting identifier prevents confirmation of the record.

C: A conflicting identifier is not a personal preference.

D: Correct. A discrepancy is a mismatch needing a check.

Check 2: A - amendment

A: Correct. An amendment is an authorized record correction or addition.

B: Booking concerns an appointment, not correction of a finalized record.

C: Dispatch concerns sending an item, not amending its recorded information.

D: Turnover concerns preparing a room.

Model response: Before this folder is used, I need to flag an identifier mismatch between the appointment list and its label. Two patients share the surname, so that name alone does not resolve it. I have held the folder and need the approved identity check. Please confirm the correct record before the team proceeds.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Laboratory cases and delivery expectations

Editing example: Noon is a delivery estimate. The team still needs to confirm arrival and clinical readiness before confirming the appointment plan.

The revision separates logistics from an authorized clinical readiness decision.

Check 1: C - estimate

A: Authorization grants permission; it does not describe uncertain timing.

B: A prescription contains clinical instructions, not a timing prediction.

C: Correct. An estimate preserves the laboratory's stated uncertainty.

D: Shade concerns color specification, not delivery time.

Check 2: A - authorized clinician

A: Correct. The assistant should refer the specification to the authorized clinician.

B: The appointment coordinator manages timing, not the prescribed clinical specification.

C: Purchasing concerns supplies; it does not establish authority to issue this prescription.

D: A laboratory courier handles transport rather than issuing the clinical prescription.

Model response: The appointment is Tuesday at two, and your current delivery estimate is noon that day. That leaves little time for the dentist's readiness check, so I cannot treat the appointment as secured by this estimate alone. Could you update us Monday at four? We will then ask the authorized team to confirm the scheduling decision.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Aftercare questions and follow-up calls

Editing example: I cannot assess that concern or reconstruct the instructions from memory. Let's use the practice's appropriate response route.

The revision avoids unsupported reassurance and guessing at clinical guidance.

Check 1: A - authorized

A: Correct. The appropriate clinician must clarify or change the guidance.

B: An informal response is not the needed assurance of authority.

C: Whether a response is recorded does not make it clinically authorized.

D: An estimate concerns uncertainty in an amount or timing, not authority to advise.

Check 2: C - callback

A: A referral directs someone to another service rather than describing a return call.

B: A recall interval is the time between planned reviews, not a return contact.

C: Correct. A callback is a return contact, not automatically an appointment.

D: A review appointment is the separate booked visit, not the promised return call.

Model response: Please tell me which phrase in the written instructions you want clarified. I can pass your question to the authorized clinician, but I should not reinterpret or change the guidance myself. We will use the appropriate contact process for your concern, and any urgent issue must follow the practice's designated urgent or emergency route.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Fictional English practice, not dental training. Permitted duties, supervision, imaging authorization, and infection-prevention procedures depend on local requirements and qualifications. Refer diagnosis, treatment decisions, informed-consent questions, and aftercare advice to the authorized dental professional.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

BLS: Dental Assistants

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/healthcare/dental-assistants.htm>

CDC: Plain Language

<https://www.cdc.gov/health-literacy/php/develop-materials/plain-language.html>

NIDCR: Dental Materials

<https://www.nidcr.nih.gov/grants-funding/funded-research/research-investments-advances/dental-materials>

National Dental Practice-Based Research Network: Impression Techniques for Single-Unit Crowns

<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC5794617/>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Dental Assisting English

Professional audience: Dental assistants and dental support staff

Scope: Fictional English practice, not dental training. Permitted duties, supervision, imaging authorization, and infection-prevention procedures depend on local requirements and qualifications. Refer diagnosis, treatment decisions, informed-consent questions, and aftercare advice to the authorized dental professional.

Lesson 01: Clarifying the appointment purpose

Original fictional case: A fictional patient arrives expecting a filling today. The schedule shows a thirty-minute consultation, and no procedure is confirmed. The dentist can clarify the purpose before the patient decides whether to continue.

Language workshop: Separate a booked discussion from a promised treatment

Communication goal: Check the appointment mismatch and explain what is confirmed.

Language guidance: 'Consultation' and 'procedure' are not interchangeable. Describe the booking you can see, acknowledge the patient's understanding, and ask the authorized person to clarify without blaming the patient or promising treatment.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): The schedule shows ____; you were expecting ____ / I haven't confirmed ____ for today's visit. / Let me check ____ before we say ____.

Vocabulary: consultation: A visit for discussing or assessing a concern with the appropriate dental professional. / procedure: A particular dental action or treatment, not simply any visit to the office. / appointment slot: A reserved period in the appointment schedule. / treatment plan: The clinician's proposed course of dental care, which requires appropriate explanation and agreement.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Patient: you took time off expecting a filling and remember discussing it by phone. You do not have a written procedure confirmation.

Guided response task: Complete a workplace dialogue by selecting one of four supplied options. Compare the feedback and say the completed exchange aloud. Do not write an open-ended message.

Optional second-round challenge: Reception finds a note saying 'discuss filling options.' Explain why that note does not by itself confirm that a filling will be performed.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: I see a thirty-minute consultation on today's schedule, but you were expecting a filling. I have not confirmed a procedure for this visit. Let me check with the dentist and reception before we describe what will happen today. Please tell us what you understood from the earlier booking conversation.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Choose grammar that preserves the meaning

1. Use the lesson's language workshop, or one actual sentence from the dialogue, to explain a single grammar distinction in no more than 90 words. Show how it affects timing, certainty, responsibility or politeness.
2. Give one brief occupational exchange containing a gap and four complete options A-D. Supply enough context for exactly one answer. Keep distractors plausible; distinguish grammar errors from wording that changes the facts. Stop and wait.
3. Explain why each choice fits or fails, then ask me to read the completed exchange aloud. Do not request a draft, original written sentence or essay.
4. Repeat with three new exchanges, one at a time, moving from recognition to a more subtle meaning contrast. Do not copy the published checks. Label invented variations and do not turn uncertainty into a promise.
5. End with a short contrast table and two supported spoken turns using supplied frames. Accept accurate alternatives in oral practice; acknowledge and replace ambiguous multiple-choice items.

END PROMPT